

Leave Policy – v2 (2025)

1. Annual holidays

Legal holidays (Coordinated Laws of 28 June 1971) plus 12 extra-legal days. Requests through the HR portal at least 2 weeks in advance for periods of more than 3 days.

2. Parental leave

2.1 Parental leave is a **statutory right** (Royal Decree of 29 October 1997). It can be taken full-time, half-time, as a 1/5 reduction, or – with the employer's agreement – as a 1/10 reduction.

2.2 The employee informs HR **in writing 2 to 3 months in advance**, by registered letter or by handing over a letter of which HR signs a duplicate. HR is the only point of contact; **managers cannot accept or refuse parental leave**.

2.3 The company may **postpone** the start of parental leave by at most **6 months** for justified reasons linked to the functioning of the company. The postponement must be communicated **in writing within one month** of the request, with reasons. Parental leave can never be refused.

2.4 The employee is protected against dismissal from the request until 3 months after the end of the leave, except for reasons unrelated to the leave.

3. Other leave

Birth leave (20 days), small leave (family events), leave for compelling reasons (CCT n° 45), time credit (CCT n° 103), palliative care leave, carer's leave.

4. Performance and leave

Taking statutory leave shall **never be held against the employee** in performance reviews, bonus or promotion decisions. Objectives are pro-rated (see Performance Management & Bonus Policy).

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